

DEAL Reflection — Rubric

Scale

All course rubrics use the same 5-point scale. This rubric applies to all DEAL Reflections; what changes is the depth your instructor expects, not the dimensions.

Level	Label
4	Exemplary
3	Proficient
2	Developing
1	Emerging
0	Not Acceptable

Dimensions

Four dimensions, equally weighted at 25% each.

Dimension	Weight	Competency → Subskill	Evaluates
Descriptive Specificity	25%	Career & Self-Development → Self-Awareness	Describe stage
Critical Examination	25%	Career & Self-Development → Reflection	Examine stage
Personal Accountability	25%	Career & Self-Development → Self-Awareness	Across all stages
Articulation of Learning	25%	Career & Self-Development → Career Articulation / Growth Orientation	Articulate Learning stage

Dimension 1: Descriptive Specificity

Career & Self-Development → Self-Awareness Evaluates the Describe stage

Level	Descriptor
Exemplary (4)	The experience is described concretely — who was involved, what was said or done, what the context was. A reader who wasn't there could reconstruct the scene. The description focuses on one specific moment or a tightly connected set of moments rather than summarizing a whole phase.
Proficient (3)	The experience is clearly identifiable and includes concrete details. A reader

	can follow what happened. The description is reasonably focused, though it may cover slightly more ground than necessary.
Developing (2)	The experience is described in general terms. A reader gets the gist but lacks the specifics needed to fully understand what happened. The description may summarize a phase rather than anchor in one specific moment.
Emerging (1)	The description is vague or abstract. It reads as a general account of the course phase rather than a specific experience. A reader cannot determine what actually happened.
Not Acceptable (0)	No meaningful description is provided. The Describe stage is missing, or the content is so generic it could apply to any student in any project.

Dimension 2: Critical Examination

Career & Self-Development → Reflection Evaluates the Examine stage

Level	Descriptor
Exemplary (4)	The examination goes beyond narration to genuine analysis. Assumptions are identified, patterns or tensions are surfaced, and the experience is connected to broader professional or personal understanding. The examination produces insight that wasn't obvious before you sat down to write.
Proficient (3)	The examination engages meaningfully with the experience. At least one assumption, pattern, or connection is identified that moves beyond surface observation. The analysis is grounded in the specific experience described rather than in general principles.
Developing (2)	The examination stays at the surface. The description is restated with evaluative language added ("this was challenging," "I learned a lot"), but the experience is not interrogated. Assumptions are not identified, patterns are not surfaced, and connections to broader understanding are generic.
Emerging (1)	The examination is minimal or absent. The reflection moves directly from description to learning claims without meaningful analysis. What is presented as examination reads as continued description or as unsupported assertion.
Not Acceptable (0)	No meaningful examination is present. The Examine stage is missing, or the content does not engage with the described experience analytically.

Dimension 3: Personal Accountability

Career & Self-Development → Self-Awareness Evaluates across all stages — whether you examine your own role, assumptions, and limitations

Level	Descriptor
Exemplary (4)	You place yourself inside the experience as an actor — examining your own assumptions, decisions, reactions, and limitations rather than only describing what happened around you. The self-examination is specific rather than formulaic, referencing particular moments or choices. Difficulty, uncertainty, or shortcoming is named in concrete terms, and your own contribution is examined rather than attributed entirely to external factors.
Proficient (3)	You examine your own role in the experience, including areas of difficulty or uncertainty. The self-examination is grounded in specific aspects of the experience rather than purely general statements. The reflection turns inward at some point rather than remaining focused only on external events.
Developing (2)	Your role is acknowledged in broad terms ("I struggled with time management") but specific decisions, assumptions, or reactions are not examined with any depth. Self-examination reads as obligatory — a limitation is named, but what drove it or what it reveals is not engaged with.
Emerging (1)	You remain largely external to the experience. The account focuses on what happened around you — team dynamics, employer behavior, project circumstances — without examining your own thinking, choices, or role in shaping the outcome.
Not Acceptable (0)	No self-examination is present. The reflection reads as a third-person account of events with no evidence that you considered your own assumptions, decisions, or role.

Dimension 4: Articulation of Learning

Career & Self-Development → Career Articulation / Growth Orientation Evaluates the Articulate Learning stage

Level	Descriptor
Exemplary (4)	The articulated learning is specific, transferable, and credibly derived from the examination. It identifies a principle, understanding, or capability that extends beyond this experience and this project. You can name where and how this learning might apply in a future context. The learning is honest — it reflects what you actually learned, not what sounds most impressive.
Proficient (3)	The articulated learning follows logically from the examination and identifies something you will carry forward. It is specific enough to be meaningful, even if the future application is not fully developed.
Developing (2)	The articulated learning is present but generic. It could apply to almost any student in any experiential learning course ("teamwork is important," "communication matters more than I thought"). The connection to the specific examination is loose — the learning statement doesn't clearly emerge from the

	analysis.
Emerging (1)	The articulated learning is vague, disconnected from the examination, or absent. What is presented reads as a general statement about the value of the experience rather than a specific insight extracted from it.
Not Acceptable (0)	No meaningful learning is articulated. The Articulate Learning stage is missing, or the content is entirely generic — it bears no visible relationship to the experience described or the examination conducted.